

## The Indians

After the Battle of Gaugamela, Alexander moved eastwards towards India. Here he met new opponents who used different weaponry and armour. As the climate was hotter and wetter in India, many of the Indian troops wore only a long white wrap-around skirt for protection.

### The infantry

The Indian infantry was generally not very disciplined or well-trained.

The troops used long two-handed slashing swords for weapons plus either javelins or bows. Some carried wooden shields.

### The cavalry

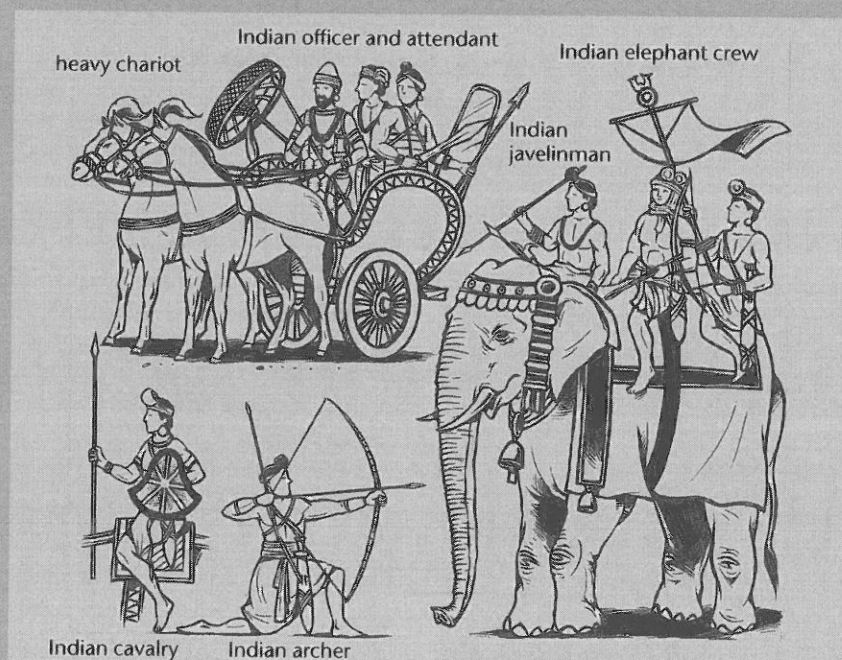
The Indian cavalry fought with javelins and swords. Their horses were specially trained to fight next to elephants. The main difference between these troops and Alexander's is that they carried shields.

### The chariots

The Indians used large, heavy chariots pulled by four horses. Each chariot had a crew of four to six men. Two men carried bows, two carried javelins and the other two carried shields and drove the chariot. The chariots were brightly decorated with pictures of the Indian gods and goddesses or patterns. Many were covered in bells and tigerskins.

### The elephants

The most unusual feature of the Indian army were the elephant units. The Indians made great use of elephants as a weapon. Each carried a crew of three or four men. One was the driver, or *mahout*. The rest carried javelins or bows to fight with. The elephants were painted in bright colours. They presented a huge obstacle to Alexander's cavalry. The Macedonian horses tended to be afraid of elephants and would not charge them or any troops near them. The horses would panic as the elephants got near. The Macedonian infantry were also not accustomed to fighting elephants. The size of these animals presented a psychological threat to the men.



### Indian troop types

## Review and analyse

- Describe Alexander's army up to the Battle of Gaugamela.
- How did it change after that battle?
- What were the main differences between the Macedonian, Persian and Indian armies?
- What advantages did the Macedonians have over the Persians and Indians?

## The major battles

Alexander's greatest achievements were his victories at the Battles of Granicus, 334BC; Issus, 333BC; Gaugamela or Arbela, 331BC; and at the River Hydaspes in India in 326BC. Our most reliable evidence for what happened at these battles comes from the ancient historian Arrian who wrote during the second century AD. We will now study those battles.